

CONTESTANT NUMBER _____

UNIVERSITY INTERSCHOLASTIC LEAGUE

COPY EDITING CONTEST

DISTRICT 2026

This test is produced, and should be graded,
using the 2024-2026 Associated Press Stylebook, 57th edition,
in print or updated on or before June 1, 2024, online.

Students may use the AP Stylebook, dictionary and/or thesaurus
during the exam.

FOR JUDGE'S USE

Points from
PART 1

Points from
PART 2

TOTAL
POINTS

POINTS/15

POINTS/20

POINTS/35

PLACE

PART 3
is graded
ONLY
to break ties.

DO NOT TURN THIS PAGE UNTIL YOU ARE INSTRUCTED TO DO SO!

RECOMMENDED EDITING MARKS

Students should use clearly understood editing symbols.

Students will NOT be penalized for using other symbols.

It is up to the judges to determine if marks are “clearly understood.”

¶ or L

¶ Leaguetown High School will undergo renovations this summer. ¶ “This is long overdue,” Principal Mike Macall said.
“I’m so glad to see it’s finally happening.”

indent for paragraph

paragraph

no paragraph

⤿

His complaints are just grapes sour.

transpose

○

They’ve been married eleven years.

use figures

She lives in Austin, TX.

spell out

○

Superintendent Lyle Keen addressed the school board

abbreviate

Jr. Joe Smith can’t wait until he’s a senior.

don’t abbreviate

≡

I love my english class.

uppercase

/

High School can be fun and interesting.

lowercase

⌒

Happy Thanks giving!

remove space

└┐

When his family moves, he will have to change high schools.

insert space

STET

He uses ^{STET} two pencils for tests.

ignore correction

↯

I can’t wait for that the movie to come out.

delete

↗

insert comma

↘

insert apostrophe

↙

insert quotation marks

⊙ ⊗

insert period

≡

insert hyphen

↘

insert dash

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DISTRICT 2026

DIRECTIONS: This test is divided into three sections. All three sections are mandatory. Write all your responses as indicated. You have 15 minutes.

PART 1: Circle the correct response. (1 pt. each)

1. My mother loves **beets** / **beats**. I hate when she serves them at dinner.
2. I always keep the **syllabi** / **syllabuses** for all of my courses to stay on track.
3. His transgression **occurred** / **incurred** a stiff penalty.
4. The **better** / **bettor** lost \$1,000 when officials disqualified the horse.
5. He plans to join the **Marine Corps** / **USMC** after graduation.
6. There were **fewer** / **less** questions on the test than I expected.
7. The office **aide** / **aid** lost his way while looking for a classroom.
8. The teacher told her students to **login** / **log in** to their computers.
9. She used four **discreet** / **discrete** voices in her performance.
10. The **questionaire** / **questionnaire** was five pages long.
11. The team won **its** / **it's** final game of the season.
12. Have you ordered any Girl Scout **cookies** / **Cookies** this year?
13. I hate to **vacuum** / **vacume** / **vaccum** more than any other household chore.
14. People were speculating on whom the next **Archbishop** / **archbishop** of Canterbury would be.
15. The principal questioned his **judgment** / **judgement** when he decided to skip school.

UIL COPY EDITING DISTRICT 2026

PART 2: Edit the following sentences to eliminate/correct FOUR (and only four) errors in wordiness, AP style, grammar, spelling or punctuation in each of the five statements below. Use clearly understood editing symbols. Spelling errors should be corrected, not simply marked for correction. Judges will only evaluate the first four corrections the contestant makes. Judges will ignore any additional corrections beyond the first four. Contestants will receive points for correct edits but will not receive points if they miss a correction, include unnecessary corrections or use unclear editing symbols. Compound errors such as changing “First Lady” to “first lady” will be considered as one error. (4 pts. each)

POINTS

0 1 2 3 4

1. The rose that is red represents romance and the rose that is

yellow represents joy, and friendship.

0 1 2 3 4

2. The Varsity soccer team beat Central high school 4 to 0 on Saturday

placing them first in the district.

0 1 2 3 4

3. Firemen arrived at the burning building 5 minutes after they recieved

the call. They worked for two hours before the flames were extenguished.

0 1 2 3 4

4. They had a picnic by the creak. It was a real smorgasbord with fired

chicken, potatoe salad, chips, chocolate cake, and cold drinks.

0 1 2 3 4

5. He was fined \$50.00 for jay-walking. He pleaded with the officer not to

give him a ticket, but it was too no avail.

TOTAL

_____/20

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PART 3: In the space provided, edit the following news brief to make the wording clear, to eliminate wordiness as well as any errors in AP style, grammar, spelling or punctuation. You do NOT have to rewrite the news brief. Make notes of anything you believe needs clarification, additional research or additional reporting. PART 3 WILL BE USED ONLY TO BREAK TIES BUT IS REQUIRED. In the event of a tie, if you do not make any effort on Part 3, your entire entry will be DISQUALIFIED.

Leaguetown ISD has made some major digital changes in this 2025-2026 school year, including the new Securely system. The Securely system is mainly used for the safety of our students and staff members, including cyber security.

One of the primary uses of this new high tech solution to our school's needs is the digital hall pass system. Once a teacher gives a digital hall pass to a student, the student is timed. Only ten students in the school are allowed to be out of class at one time. This program has the additional benefit of allowing school staff members to see where students are while in the building.

Vice Principal, Mrs. Lizbeth Reynolds, is a fan of the new Securely system. She stated that in the first twelve days of school, more than 2,000 digital hall passes were created. "The biggest pro of Securely Pass is knowing where every student is in case of an emergency," said Reynolds.

High School art teacher, Sam Norton, praised the Securely passes. "Teachers and staff are able to keep up with students a lot more and it has cut off the number of students leaving the classroom to mess around," said Norton. He went on to quip, "If the school wouldn't pay for it, I would've bought it myself."

The Securely system also scans any adults that comes into the school, checking their state IDs. This has offered a sense of safety to school personnel who are working to make the school district a more secure environment for students.

COPY EDITING CONTEST DISTRICT 2026

ANSWER KEY

PART I

1. beets

2. syllabuses

3. incurred

4. bettor

5. Marine Corps

6. fewer

7. aide

8. log in

9. discrete

10. questionnaire

11. its

12. Cookies

13. vacuum

14. archbishop

15. judgment

PART 2

1. The ^{red}rose ~~that is red~~ represents romance and the ^{yellow}rose ~~that is yellow~~

represents joy and friendship.

2. The Varsity soccer team beat Central high school ⁴⁻⁰~~4 to 0~~ on Saturday

placing them first in the district.

3. ^{fighters}Firemen arrived at the burning building ⁵~~5~~ minutes after they received

the call. They worked for two hours before the flames were ⁱextinguished.

4. They had a picnic by the creek. It was a real smorgasbord with ^efried

chicken, ^gpotatoe salad, chips, chocolate cake, ^gand cold drinks.

5. He was fined \$50, ^g~~00~~ for jay ^awalking. He pleaded with the officer not to

give him a ticket, but it was ^gtoo no avail.

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You are editing for the March 27 issue of the Leaguetown School Press in Leaguetown, Texas.

NOTES TO JUDGES

¶1 — Needs to be tightened.
Never use first person.

¶5 — Second sentence needs attribution or it is an opinion.

Tips for judges

Part 3

This section is ranked to break a tie in the combined scores of parts 1 and 2. Assign no points.

Judges should compare the papers of students who tied, ranking them accordingly.

When judging Part 3, holistically read the changes the student indicated starting with the highest level of editing..

- Highest level: Are there any legal or ethical issues with the story?

- Middle level: Does the story use the right sources? Does it flow?

- Lowest level: Grammar, spelling, punctuation, style.

..

~~The district introduced the Securely system this year to improve safety.~~

Leaguetown ISD has made some major digital changes in this 2025-2026 school year, including the new Securely system. ~~The Securely system is mainly used for the safety of our students and staff members, including cyber security.~~

One of the primary uses of this new high tech solution ^{the} to our school's needs is the digital hall pass system. ^g Once a teacher gives a digital hall pass to a student, the student is timed. Only ^g ~~ten~~ students ~~in the school~~ are allowed to be out of class at one time. This program ^{also} ~~has the additional benefit of~~ ^g allowing ^s school staff members ^g to see where students are while in the building.

Vice Principal, ^g ~~Mrs.~~ Lizbeth Reynolds, ^g is a fan of the new Securely system. She ^g ~~said~~ ^g that in the first ^g ~~twelve~~ days of school, more than 2,000 digital hall passes were created. [¶] "The biggest pro of Securely Pass is knowing where every student is in case of an emergency," ^g ~~said~~ Reynolds.

~~High School~~ ^g art teacher, Sam Norton, ^g praised the Securely passes. [¶] "Teachers and staff are able to keep up with students a lot more and it has cut off the number of students leaving the classroom to mess around," ^g ~~said~~ Norton. ^g ~~He went on to quip,~~ "If the school wouldn't pay for it, I would've bought it myself."

The Securely system also scans any adults ^{who} ~~that~~ comes into the school, checking their state IDs. ~~This has offered a sense of safety to school personnel who are working to make the school district a more secure environment for students.~~